

InnoD E-Board Applications — Fall 2026

11 candidates applied across 6 VP positions. This report presents every applicant's full, unedited responses organized by position. VP of UI/UX drew the most interest with 4 applicants, followed by VP of (Graphic) Design with 3. VP of Community, VP of Externals, VP of Marketing, and VP of Photo each received 1 application.

11	6	4	3	1	1
Total Applicants	VP Positions	UI/UX Candidates	Design Candidates	Externals Candidate	Photo Candidate

I. VP of Community — Adwithi Yarida

Applicant Info	Email	adwithiy@usc.edu
	Graduating	May 2028
	First Choice	VP of Community
	Other Positions	—
	InnoD Roles	General Member, Committee Intern
	Submitted	5/22/2026, 9:43 PM
	Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Vision for the Community
Committee next semester

200+ WORDS

Next semester more than ever, community is important. We have so many graduating seniors, so it's super important to be able to keep the wonderful vibes that InnoD has going when it comes to next year. One of my biggest visions is strengthening the hex class next semester. I want to make sure that this hex class is the strongest

and most involved ever, starting from how we recruit. I think we should incorporate personality and involvement as a big factor so that the club keeps going and continues to have people that genuinely want to contribute to the community and be active within it.

I also really want to focus on how the hex class bonds. I want there to be more challenges, bonding activities, and opportunities for people to get to know each other more naturally so they can build closer friendships early on, especially before retreat. Another important part of my vision is helping people transition from being a new member into an integrated part of the club through the many mini-communities we already have established, like fams and lineages, while also encouraging more niche communities like innorave, innohammock, and any other communities that we create along the way. InnoD is already very good at integrating new members into the club, but naturally some people end up closer to the community than others, and I think it helps for new members to have one more mini community where they can feel especially comfortable and connected.

We're also likely going to have a HUGE hex class next semester, with many new freshmen, so I really want to prioritize integrating them and making them closer with each other and the club as a whole. Another thing I want to focus on is spotlighting more members of InnoD and celebrating the people that make the club what it is. InnoD is a family, and its community is what makes it so special, and I want to be able to showcase that to the world through collaborations with the marketing committee so people can really see who we are and what we do.

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

I'm interested in this role because InnoD genuinely means a lot to me. I joined as a fresh transfer last semester, but honestly I had wanted to join even before transferring to USC because I clocked InnoD off of innoshoot photos I saw from someone from my high school. Since joining, the people of InnoD have made my first year at USC so much more meaningful.

When I was pledging Alpha Zeta last year, it was an incredibly isolating time for me. I was struggling with my physical health, mental health, academic/extracurricular commitments, socially, and more, and InnoD gave me a space to breathe and forget about my tasks during that period of my life. Even after I ended up dropping and was dealing with the after-effects of all of that isolation and stress, I was able to turn to the people of InnoD because they were so welcoming, and that support genuinely meant a lot to me.

Beyond the friendships and sidequesting, InnoD also helped me grow creatively. Coming from STEM-heavy environments like the Bay Area and Purdue, I never really saw photography or creativity as more than a hobby, but InnoD's community and passion showed me how creativity can help you grow, connect, innovate, and keep learning.

I'm also a people person at heart. I love planning random activities, brainstorming events, and bringing energy into spaces. Throughout high school I was class president for four years, so I already have experience with event planning, fundraising, brainstorming, and being a loud and active representative voice. As we go through a lot of changes next year, I want to help be that community and safe space for the next generation of InnoD, especially by helping future hex classes become closer and more connected than mine was.

How would you tackle the challenge of mobilizing members for community events?

200+ WORDS

I think a big part of this starts from recruitment. We have a pretty big opportunity to shape our community a lot this semester based on who we recruit, so I think it's really important to place an emphasis on people that genuinely enjoy social events, community, and being involved. Obviously talent and creativity matter a lot, but I also think it's important to recruit people that are down for a good time and want to contribute to the overall energy and vibes of the club.

Another challenge is current members becoming jaded or less motivated over time. One thing I noticed this semester was that a lot of people showed up to the first kickback because it was an opportunity to get points for fams. I think similar incentives for social events could help encourage engagement and create more excitement around participation.

I also want to get more feedback from members about what kinds of events they actually want to attend. I think people are a lot more likely to show up when they feel like they have a voice in shaping the community and the events we host. Overall, I think building engagement comes down to creating a culture where people genuinely enjoy being around each other and feel excited to participate.

How would you lead and organize your team to ensure smooth operations?

100+ WORDS

I want to run the Community Committee efficiently while still keeping it collaborative and fun. Structurally, I want the committee to feel pretty horizontal because everyone in community is there for a reason and everyone has great ideas. I want us to constantly brainstorm together, throw ideas back and forth, and build events and initiatives as a team. A big thing for me is making sure everyone on the committee is super invested and hype, because I think the good energy and community vibes come from the top.

I see my role as representing and leading the overarching vision for community while also coordinating and delegating tasks between different chairs. Chairs are there for a reason and they're good at what they do, so I think operations run a lot smoother when everyone is trusted to take ownership of the parts they're strongest at while still collaborating closely with each other. I also want to make sure every chair feels supported not just by me, but by another chair as well (e.g. Events + Fund Chairs and New Mem + Fam Chairs).

With a bigger emphasis on hex class bonding next semester, I also want the new member chair to be more visible and more involved with planning activities (potentially alongside the events and fundraising chairs). I also want to pay more attention to interns because I think the role was a little undefined this year and therefore people did not participate. I still want interns to have freedom and ownership over what they explore, but I want to recruit interns specifically interested in brainstorming fundraising ideas or events/intern GMs so everyone has a clearer role and way to contribute. Overall, I want to lead with good energy so that the committee reflects that energy, and in turn the club does too.

Fun community events and fundraising efforts

- Fam cooking contest lol
- Poster + sticker sale
- Bake sale/apartment cafe
- Headshot fundy
- ASSASSINS!! or some variant of this (btg did this, could ask them how that worked) — ~50% of funds goes to club, ~50% goes to winners (percentages can be changed)
- Hex class challenges:
 - • Make a music video during hex class hangout (make that mandatory btw) → shown at retreat or other event
 - • Scavenger hunt
 - • Hex class fundy: hex class has a specified amount of time to plan and execute a fundraiser (makes them closer together)

	• Grad shoot fundy (collab with media) (could double as client project): ◦ • Babysitters club style: we advertise that we have a group of photographers to do grad shoots, clients contact innod directly and can get assigned a photographer ◦ • Feel like a good target audience for this could be club grad shoots ◦ • Grad shoots are hella money → 1 is like half a client project ◦ • Photographers can get a cut (negotiable) • Advertise innod's mini community slack channels more • Joint fundragers?
Relevant past experience	• InnoD community intern — basically singlehandedly brainstormed + planned + executed intern GM; got insight into how community operates, what she would want to do next year • Class president in high school — event planning (prom, homecoming, graduation); fundraiser planning (spring fling, food fundraisers, night markets); representative of class to overall community, had a big role in making sure class was rallied + hyped and had a strong bond • Marshall AI Association VP of Marketing — introduced and planned a lot of community concepts including retreat, big/little
Other Details	Would consider chair position if not selected: Yes Other commitments: Avenues consulting group, venture capital academy, part time job?

II. VP of Externals — Aditya Mishra

Applicant Info	Email	mishraad@usc.edu
	Graduating	May 2027
	First Choice	VP of Externals
	Other Positions	VP of Community
	InnoD Roles	General Member
	Submitted	5/18/2026, 2:42 PM
	Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Vision for the Externals Committee next semester	Yes. Mishra in Externals. After finishing my first semester at InnoD and my first semester ever in a USC club, I've felt a very responsible
--	---

(almost maternal) desire to take this club to the next level.

Community is what makes InnoD what it is. It makes coming to weekly GMs fun. It's the reason why snipe culture is probably more competitive than getting into LavaLab. That said, what Gina and Aaron (you guys) brought up during your speech reflects what the club needs going forward: Professionalism. And I see those first steps to professionalism, without making it sound boring and stressful, pioneered by Externals.

I envision InnoD becoming a channel for students to grow and enhance their dormant design thinking. This means throwing one big weekend hackathon each semester (like CreateSC) with major collaboration and a theme.

For the next semester, I am already in talks with World Labs, a spatial intelligence company building 3D worlds using AI and Gaussian Splats pioneered by Fei-Fei Li ("godmother of AI"), to throw a USC-wide hackathon. If this event could be organized under the primary collaboration of InnoD alongside support from TroyLabs, LavaLabs, the School of Cinematic Arts, Marshall, etc., (both clubs and schools), InnoD will be at the center of fostering a community of designers and creators, with the help of promising companies.

Externals commits to hosting high-quality events. But those high-quality events are nothing without certain values. In Japan, there is a belief, "Omotenashi," which means expecting a guest's needs without expecting anything in return. I want to teach Omotenashi in InnoD and have it be the reason people can look up to the InnoD brand with comfort, and with respect.

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

A big part of why I want to run for Externals VP is my commitment this past year to pursuing things I'm not naturally good at. And I refuse to stop until I get better. For example, I'm still a bum when it comes to product design. I literally started it nine months ago, but became obsessed with improving. I want to bring that determination to external outreach.

Outside of InnoD, I co-founded tlocal, a localization tool, where I personally led external outreach to industry professionals at Sony, Crunchyroll, and Disney Animation. Outreach is nothing new to me. (and on a personal note, the job market for international students has basically assaulted me AND taught me that nothing can happen without good outreach. Email writing is an art. I've learnt so much just this year).

I think the World Labs hackathon is an example I'm most excited for. This \$1 billion funded company was extraordinarily hard to reach. But I kept going, kept finding new approaches, and eventually got the conversation started, and convinced them to throw a USC collaborated event.

I believe one landmark event does more for a club's brand than five smaller ones. A single, well-executed, demo-level hackathon in partnership with a company like World Labs puts InnoD on the map in a way that compounds semester after semester. College Designers across the country will look forward. That's the standard I want to build toward.

What large-scale events would you implement to strengthen external presence?

200+ WORDS

I want to rethink how InnoD finds its sponsors and partners. Right now, that responsibility largely falls on leadership. I want to change that. Tongfei, is a huge Monster fan, and it made me realize that our members already have deep enthusiasm for brands and companies they'd love to see collaborate with InnoD. I want to formalize it through a new chair role within Externals. Let's call it the "Ambassador Program Chair," whose job is to facilitate and encourage members to proactively reach out to companies they care about. It makes sponsorship outreach more distributed, gives members real professional experience, and builds a culture where everyone feels invested in InnoD's external growth. To motivate members, hefty family points would be earned for each sponsor, whose money, once calculated for surplus, could be used to raise the bar on fam prizes!

On the events side, the initiative I'm most passionate about is building out InnoD's alumni network. InnoD alumni are working at incredible places, but right now, there's no real infrastructure connecting them back to current members. Through Externals, I want to create that linkage: alumni speaker series, mentorship pipelines, portfolio reviews. If InnoD members are so willing to coffee chat each others, they should be thrilled to reach out to professional networks within InnoD's alumni circle too!

How would you create a coalition between creative clubs on campus?

200+ WORDS

I want to build a connective tissue between clubs, and I'd do it in two steps.

Step 1: Start with a roundtable. I want to get the external leads and presidents of USC's creative orgs in the same room. I want us all to talk. What culture does each club want to foster? What do their members need? What overlaps exist? I believe this kind of collaboration can only happen if InnoD takes the initiative in shuttle diplomacy (going up to every club president in advance to pitch the idea).

Step 2: Introduce friendly competition. Interclub competitions bring value to clubs. TroyLabs, SEP, and LavaLab openly compete to be the best entrepreneurship ecosystem on campus, and yet the majority of their members have been in two or all three, and have done their best work, not in spite of rivalry. The same dynamic can work for us creative clubs.

Friendly competition raises the bar of quality, deepens intraculture, and builds each club's brand across USC. I'm still figuring out what this may look like in steps, but I'm sure it will take time. My role as VP of Externals might not show immediate effect, but the first slow-burning step in the right direction is necessary to achieve the cross-campus brand and network that Externals has the potential to provide.

How would you lead and organize your team?

100+ WORDS

It's hard for me to determine right now whether adding or removing chair roles would better serve the committee without further communication with the presidents to align external goals.

Looking at the chair roles, I believe a small team of 3 (including the VP of Externals) is a minimum and a solid starting point. An engagement chair / social chair is definitely necessary, given my plans above that require a lot of outreach and talking. I'd ideally want someone with VP of Community energy to fill that role. Logistics chair will also prove necessary.

Primarily, I'd want each chair member to have their own moment to shine throughout the semester. If it's the semesterly hackathon, I want to bring out the best in Logistics. If we're facilitating alumni circles and interclub roundtables, I want to bring out the best in Social.

Relevant past experience

- **Co-Founder, tLocal (March 2026 – Present):** Built tLocal, a production-ready localization QC tool, targeting workflow operational inefficiencies in media localization using TwelveLabs' Marengo & Pegasus video intelligence models. Won 1st place at TwelveLabs Video Intelligence Hackathon (120 applicants), judged by Baseten, LTX, Nvidia, AWS, Kartel. Experience with participating in, and planning out hackathons.
- **Operations Management Instructor Assistant (Aug 2024 – Jan 2025), USC Marshall:** Mentored 700+ students on Process Optimization, Queuing, & Inventory Management, improving 80% of test scores.

Other Details

Would consider Externals chair if not selected: Yes

Other commitments: Post grad recruitment; perhaps another club; throwing that World Labs Hackathon (regardless)

Anything else: "I'm excited for InnoD's future. It's bright. Ahh, I see... the light."

III. VP of Marketing – Christy Li

Applicant Info

Email	cli48022@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2028
First Choice	VP of Marketing
Other Positions	—

InnoD Roles	General Member, Committee Chair, Committee Intern
Submitted	4/30/2026, 10:14 PM
Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Vision for the Marketing Committee next semester

200+ WORDS

1 Team:

(1) Team critique: In current marketing meeting, the chairs just wait for feedback VP's one by one and it's a waste of the in person communication opportunity. Thus, for the future marketing meetings, I would love to encourage chairs to provide feedbacks to each other to increase not only their work quality by hearing from different perspectives, but also allow them to get to know each other better and train their critical design thinking.

(2) Clear shared goals: Current marketing deliverables, due dates, resources are scattered around different platforms, group chats, and pages. I want to organize the communication platform, tracker etc. as clear as possible and make the working process more intuitive.

(3) Team bonding: I want to bring chairs to hang out at least once per semester (shout out to media team they are doing so great on that)! and also have a more proper chat sesh during the first meeting to help them know the teammates.

2 Chairs:

(1) Branding chair: My personal experience was good help making the typography, social media posts template etc. but I also want the future branding chairs can actually develop the whole brand guide (if they want to) so they can learn more professional knowledge from this experience.

(2) Merch chair: Overall merch chair is doing pretty good, the only thing I am currently thinking (a really random thought) is inspired by Joanna - what if innod merch can be sold on our website as a way for fundraising (low priority tho)

(3) Historian & content chair: I am still considering to combine historian chair & content chair, because there was nothing to do for the historian chair this semester after InnoShoot. However, the workload (whether keeping historian & content separately or not) might depends on the chair commitment and I would love to talk to y'all about your expectation of the leadership roles size.

(4) Web chair (new): This is a new role that I want to add because I want to push the web design more. I think a shared vision of us is making InnoD beyond the campus, and one of the main methods for

people beyond our campus to know our brand identity is our website. BUT, currently the website is just a task if some chairs want to contribute to it, it's not a high priority, so the website building have been procrastinated for few semesters.

3 Events:

(1) Large Merch (clothes) Design Competition (lower priority): Inspired by Creative Labs, since the merch are for our members, it will be fun if all of them can contribute to it! The design process will not be in GMs, we can just have a google form to collect volunteered design and make a vote in GM. Then the merch chair can revise and elaborate the design with the highest votes.

4 Other detail expectations:

(1) Merch: Let's make something fun and cool! A current one in my mind is InnoUno 🤪

(2) Hex color: jacqueline told me about the red, yellow, green, blue cycle. Maybe we can do something green & blue-ish.....?

(3) In person posters for big events: USC has such a great traffic! We should print some of our amazing graphics out for CreateSC & Riptide to reach larger audiences in our campus

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

First, my experience as the Branding Chair let me have a deep understanding of the current marketing committee structure, and this allowed me to identify effective patterns worth maintaining and potential areas for improvement. Thus, I am confident in my ability to bring meaningful changes to marketing committee.

For myself personally, I want to challenge myself beyond being a hands-on designer. I had experiences creating content myself, but I also want to learn how to lead a team that consistently produces work aligned with a clear vision without me actually doing large portion of design. I'm also interested in improving my ability to manage multiple roles, coordinate timelines, and communicate expectations as clearly and effectively as possible.

For the marketing team itself, my 2 main visions / goals are: (1) stronger team collaboration and bonding and (2) empower creativity and innovation

Lets make InnoD brand identity great again 🔥🔥

How do you plan to organize/leverage your committee to deliver design assets?

200+ WORDS

- **First meeting:** make expectations to teammates clear (discuss team norms, like communication style and how to track tasks etc.), clarify chair ownership at the beginning of the semesters
- **Goal tracking:** Notion page for long term goals, overall calendar & timeline (central tracker, mark the date as soon as possible); Imsg for weekly deliverables / reminder. For each content brief assign: who, tasks, due date (1-3 days before the ACTUAL due date), status.
- **File management:** Figma page (branding, merch, website brainstorm make the iterations in timely order) + google drive (InnoShoot, content), and write down all the links on corresponding Notion section
- **Design system and templates:** create a main branding guideline Figma page, and make quick templates not only for the GM slides but also for IG stories, reel cover, event promo, reusable elements
- **Weekly meeting:** marketing committee internal check-in (clarify the weekly deliverables, updating both on imsg and notion page) + encourage team critique & discussion for different deliverables to gain different perspectives
- **InnoD GM department break out:** check-in & critique with other departments and presidents
- **Communication:** always provide clear feedback that is not vague, encourage early stage review of chairs (check in shared files or ask them throughout the process and don't wait for the end to provide feedback), regular DM check in (checking the chair's availability for the task and condition)

How would you lead and organize your team?

100+ WORDS

All of the answers from the last question plus:

1 Team:

- First meeting: ice breaker (YAP / informal cc) + make expectations to teammates clear (discuss team norms, like communication style and how to track tasks etc.)
- Team bonding activity: at least once hang per semester
- How I will work with them: I want them to gain as much as possible from the experience, so my role would primarily be to provide guidance, oversight, and step in for final decisions when needed. I would also be the first to step in and help resolve any urgent issues that arise, whether related to individuals or specific tasks.
- Decision-making structure: chairs do low-stakes decisions (e.g. brainstorming/iterations...), both VP and chairs do mid-stake decisions (e.g. single post design), VP, chairs & prez do high-stakes (e.g. semester branding guideline finalize) together.
- Team culture and goal: creativity, professional growth, fun!

2 Chairs:

I am currently considering combining the Historian and Content Chair roles, as well as introducing a Web Design Chair :)

Other Details

Portfolio: www.hylstudio.work *lowk chopped rn

Would consider Marketing chair if not selected: Yes

Other commitments: Joining one of the RSO here: Terra studio / PAC / ZAP, as a general member; Creator Corner event lead (can collab w InnoD)

Anything else: "thank you for reading all of these tehe <3 — also would love to provide ideas on InnoD structure overall and small visions for other departments — for portfolio I can send extra works that are not on my website yet :,)"

IV. VP of UI/UX — Kenzie Gill

Applicant Info

Email	kkgill@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2027
First Choice	VP of UIUX
Other Positions	—
InnoD Roles	General Member, Project Manager, Committee Intern

Submitted

5/18/2026, 5:48 PM

Can attend Mon
8–10PM

Of course

Why are you interested in this
particular role?

100+ WORDS

InnoD has been a huge part of my USC experience since freshman spring, and I'm going into my sixth semester now (I know, I'm old). That means I've seen the club go through a lot, including the Charles and Elissa era when the whole structure got overhauled including the whole addition of fams and the eboard overhaul. They helped shape InnoD into the community it is now and watching that happen taught me how important good leadership is into shaping the club. I genuinely believe that our work as a club has gotten better since we've all become closer.

I want to be VP of UI/UX specifically because this department is where I've grown the most. I joined freshman year with almost no design experience and now I have a portfolio, an internship lined up, and a real sense of what I want to do after USC. A lot of that came from the designers and VPs who cared enough to teach me bits and pieces of what they knew along the way. As a senior I want to be that person for the next group of designers coming in. I've also paid close attention to the VPs who've had this role before me and I've thought a lot about what's worked, what I'd build on, and where I want to bring my own ideas.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of UI/UX

200+ WORDS

The first thing I'd want to focus on is actually building out a real education and mentorship structure for designers. InnoD is where I learned most of what I know about UX, and a lot of new designers join specifically because they want skills they can take into industry. But right now that learning kind of just happens through osmosis on projects, which works okay but can leave beginner designers feeling overwhelmed or unsupported and lead to subpar work. Jason did a great job starting workshop programming this past year and I want to take that further. My idea is a required foundational curriculum every semester for new designers, taught by me, covering the basics like Figma, research methods, and core design principles. The fun part would be optional drop-in workshops on more specialized stuff, taught by whoever's actually good at the thing. Someone in the club who's a wizard at motion design could teach that, I could teach AI tools in the design workflow since that's something I've spent a lot of time on, and eventually I'd want to bring in industry guests too. Maybe we could also open the optional ones up to people outside of InnoD, partly because more designers across campus should get access to this kind of learning, and partly because it puts the club in front of a wider audience which could help us pull in those industry guests down the line.

My second focus is portfolio stuff. UX/UI portfolios are their own specific beast and pretty different from a general design portfolio, and honestly building one is a big reason people join InnoD in the first place. I'd host an end of semester workshop just for turning that semester's InnoD project into a case study people can actually put in front of recruiters.

I'd also want to bring in InnoD alumni who are now working in design for guest critiques during the semester as part of the critique process. Getting feedback from people who are actually doing this for a living is huge, and most students don't get that kind of exposure until their first internship.

I know this is a lot to try to accomplish in a single year, and I'm not expecting all of it to be fully built out by the time I'm done. But I'd at least want to lay the foundations for these initiatives so they can keep growing after I'm gone.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

My first semester as a project manager at InnoD was actually on the graphic design side, which made sense because my original experience in the club was in graphic design before I switched over to UX. But by that point all of my coursework and professional experience had been in UX, so I didn't really know much about graphic design principles or how to actually do the work (shoutout Aaron, you helped me a lot that semester). It was also my first time PMing at all, so I was figuring that out too.

At first things weren't going super well. I'd assign tasks and they'd come back late and they often weren't what I had in mind. I was getting frustrated when I kept asking and things didn't really change. It would have been easy to just blame my team and push harder, but I stopped and asked them straight up what I could be doing differently to make this work better. They told me my instructions were too vague and didn't give them enough to go on. So I started writing out way more detailed briefs, including visual examples of what I was picturing, on top of the verbal direction I was already giving. Things turned around pretty quickly after that. Honestly the biggest thing I took from it was that opening up the conversation when they felt uncomfortable expressing their feelings and not assuming the problem was on someone else's end made a huge difference.

Past UI/UX or leadership experience

- Graphic Design Project Manager - InnoD - Fall 2025
- UX/UI Project Manager - InnoD - Spring 2026
- Product Design Intern - Sumo Logic - Summer 2026
- Product Design Intern - Editorial - Summer 2025
- Freelance Website Design - Projects here and there since Fall 2024

Other Details

Best trait for a UI/UX designer: "Humility. Don't be afraid of feedback and don't get attached to your work. You can always learn something from anyone, including people with 'less experience' than you. Some of the best notes I've gotten have come from people who weren't designers at all."

Portfolio: kenziegill.framer.website (needs a little updating)

Other commitments: My Sorority (not leadership just normal member); part time work for a startup

V. VP of UI/UX — Anushka Rane

Applicant Info

Email

arrane@usc.edu

Graduating	May 2028
First Choice	VP of UIUX
Other Positions	—
InnoD Roles	General Member, Project Manager
Submitted	5/18/2026, 8:33 PM
Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

I am interested in the VP of UI/UX role at InnoD because it connects my aspirations in product design/management with my passion for mentorship and building community. One of the most valuable things I have taken from being at USC is the people I am surrounded by and the amount I've grown from learning from others. I want to create more of those moments for other designers, especially newer members who may still be building confidence in their technical skills or design thinking.

I'm also interested in the role because I want to continue developing the mentorship and structure side of design leadership. As a PM, I enjoyed helping guide communication/feedback, anticipating client needs, and creating organized systems that helped both designers and clients feel more supported.

Lastly, in addition to internal responsibilities, I'm also excited by the opportunity to learn more about the business and client-facing side of design. I want to get more experience with client recruiting and talking to people about what design could do to help them.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of UI/UX

200+ WORDS

[1] Improving the GM curriculum and support system. I want to build on InnoD's current UI/UX curriculum and provide more guidance that helps GMs grow both technically and creatively. I believe that Figma and other design software is something that designers often pick up through trial and error, and familiarity levels may vary across GM's - some might need more guidance than others. I want to hold design jam sessions, like "office hours", to help with the learning curve that designers might face, and then use design curriculum time (during weekly breakouts and outside if needed) to introduce relevant, forward-thinking topics in design that are relevant to designers' career and future projects beyond InnoD. Some ideas I have are introducing AI prototyping tools, teaching how to think through and test design decisions, and presenting work in a way that is useful for both client communication and portfolio case studies. My goal is to help GMs become more aware of the broader world of product design and encourage them to explore areas they are genuinely interested in on their own. Outside of GM, I would hold design jam sessions biweekly for technical design help, getting second opinions, and also building community between the designers - especially as people are getting used to their tools and eye. I found this approach as a PM last semester, where some things I tried were recording a tutorial video for component sets in a way that was relevant to our project, and holding a design jam session to bounce ideas off of each other and help with Framer buildout.

[2] Creating more structured guidance for UI/UX PMs. I want PMs to feel more confident making decisions independently while still having strong support when needed. A big part of this is helping them establish communication systems early, both internally with their teams and externally with clients. In my experience, creating a strong communication cadence made it much easier to handle shifting deliverables, last-minute feedback, and changing client expectations. I would guide PMs through things like structuring client calls, planning project meetings, preparing for feedback sessions, and anticipating handoff needs ahead of time. For example, last semester I created a Framer CMS curriculum and exercise for clients a few weeks before handoff so they would feel more comfortable maintaining the site afterward. I'd like to help PMs think proactively in similar ways and become stronger leaders throughout the semester. Alongside more formal check-ins, I also want to be a consistent soundboard PMs can come to whenever they need advice or another perspective.

[3] Recruiting more product-oriented client projects. I want to recruit more product-oriented client projects that push designers to think more deeply about functionality and user experience in addition to craft. I'd like to further tap into startup networks and nonprofits. I think bringing in more product-focused work would

help members develop skills that are directly applicable to modern UI/UX careers while also making projects more engaging and collaborative.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

One conflict I dealt with with my client was a misunderstanding of the user flow that was realized after low fidelity designs had already been built out. They wanted to include external articles, external resource links, as well as their own internal newsletter, but there was a lot of confusion around how those different types of content should coexist in the experience. Later on, I defined the distinction more clearly between internal and external content, but at one point the clients even asked to remove the CMS for their internal newsletter altogether. I realized that the clients themselves were still unsure of what they wanted and what would actually work best for the user flow.

Instead of immediately pushing one solution, I decided to present 3 ideas based on their expectations and clearly communicate the thought process behind each option. I presented the possibility of using a CMS for both internal and external articles versus the design team creating a simpler template where they would upload PDFs themselves. They decided to move forward with the CMS approach while reworking the structure by adding a dedicated "Resources and Reports" page and adjusting the articles page.

Throughout the back and forth with the clients through emails and calls, I made sure to organize their feedback into clear, confirmable changes before relaying anything to the designers. I wanted to minimize unnecessary revisions that could cause the design team to lose momentum while still making sure the clients got what they came for. I also made a point to clearly outline my concerns in a question > result format both verbally and in writing so expectations stayed aligned. Once we finalized the direction, I went back to the designers, summarized the reasoning behind the changes, adjusted the deliverables, and gave them additional time to work through the updates.

Past UI/UX or leadership experience

- Lavalab Product Designer (Spring 2026): led end-to-end building of design system, user flow through interviews and testing, product screens, and pitch
- InnoD UI/UX Project Manager (Spring 2026): facilitated design review sessions and client meetings
- TroyLabs Designer (Spring – Fall 2025): sole designer for one SaaS and one CPG startup (through accelerator BUILD program) doing ground-up branding, UI/UX design, pitch, and marketing design.
- Freelance work spanning product and graphic design

Other Details

Best trait for a UI/UX designer: "I believe good design makes things work unobtrusively. For traits in UI/UX designers, that clarity comes from thoughtfulness: listening to your users and designing with

intention. In today's world especially, a designer should be able to put themselves in the shoes of not only their users, but also their collaborators > clients, engineers, etc."

Portfolio: anushkarane.world

Other commitments: Campus job &/or internship; active in Lavalab & Troylabs (not as a designer)

VI. VP of UI/UX – Joshua Placido

Applicant Info	Email	jplacido@usc.edu
	Graduating	May 2027
	First Choice	VP of UIUX
	Other Positions	—
	InnoD Roles	General Member, Committee Intern
	Submitted	5/22/2026, 11:11 PM (resubmitted; original 5/19/2026)
	Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

My path to UI/UX materialized as a result of mentorship, inquisition and friendly tools. From conversations with IYA students, to Figma rabbit holes, to the frictionless experience of tools like Framer, I fell in love with the process as much as the result.

Design as an industry is arguably a lower barrier to entry, as the arts are innately more intuitive than abstract disciplines like engineering. Yet the frameworks that should be imposed to make designs implementable, scalable and seamless are often what falls between the cracks.

As a Cognitive Science major, there is limited formal curriculum to design principles, often leaving me questioning the depth of my knowledge as a designer. Yet the UI/UX curriculum, structure of client work and even short-lived conversations with other InnoD members have given me a sense of cushioning and understanding of creativity that is unmarked anywhere else on campus.

When I first joined InnoD in Fall 2025, I learned firsthand the importance of a unified team in WAVCARDS. By delegating tasks and having sync meetings, we quickly progressed through the entire deliverable scope, all the while having space to critique each others' design processes. Having a mutual respect for the craft of design,

and the safe environment to push others to their creative limits, is exactly the pressurized environment needed to match the pace of a constantly-evolving design landscape. I would be honored to contribute to that environment and pay that forward.

Among my past leadership roles, I've seen firsthand how fulfilling it is to provide others with the infrastructure needed to grow as a creative. In The OK Foundation, where creatives are pushed to incorporate different mediums, it is extremely fulfilling to see how, with the right resources, members can push beyond their own definition of creativity and carve a space that fits them.

VP of UI/UX means providing members with the resources to be a good UI/UX designer, but ultimately nuancing their definition of creativity and their professional goals, whether within UI/UX or beyond.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of UI/UX

200+ WORDS

I believe one of the biggest improvements to client recruitment that can be implemented is targeted outreach. With such a vast alumni network, I believe it would be opportune to tap into our own past members that are working on startups. I would also like to target larger tech companies: reaching out to alumni who have previously worked at those locations.

I would like to conduct outreach that is tailored to the company's current products and services; for example, providing instances of how that company can improve their work, and attaching examples of our past work. By proving that you've done research to that company, you are able to more fully highlight the level of service InnoD can provide.

A nuance I want to highlight within these different-sized companies is the level of ownership and accessibility in these project scopes. For smaller clients, design work has more ownership, and tangible results are more identifiable through a smaller feedback loop. But with larger businesses, you have to jump through more hoops coordinating with multiple stakeholders to fully implement an idea. Determining the impact we want clients to have on our GMs/PMs, based on client size, is something that I look forward to discussing with the rest of E-Board, which will ultimately guide my approach for client recruitment.

One way this can be achieved is to further the notion of a "tiered" client. Some projects can require more abstract UX thinking, while others can focus on UI redesign and working closely with design. This can broaden the scope of UI/UX curriculum and increase opportunities for cross-functional thinking. I saw the success of this as a GM for Bunky; I would love to use client recruitment as momentum to scale our opportunities for professional growth, matching the fast-changing design landscape.

Within the design curriculum, I would love to continue implementing a more strict curriculum on UI/UX and product design principles. Within my time at LavaLab, and as a UI/UX GM, I learned about different ideas and principles that have continuously anchored and nuanced my approach as a designer. Gauging the collective skillset of GMs, and coordinating with other creative service roles, I would love to create a tailored curriculum that allows GMs to moer confidently oscillate between high- and low-level approaches to design (e.g., workshops on personal branding, component libraries, etc.).

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

As Co-President of The OK Foundation, a member reported that a team member had ostracized their fellow team members out of their project, causing them to be less involved in the community.

To investigate this situation, my Co-President and I covertly requested to have low-stakes conversations with everyone in the project, collecting a high-level and objective understanding of the incident. As a result, we sat down with this member in-person and explained that they were not able to participate in a project for that semester.

This decision came as a result of protecting the integrity and collaborative culture our club praises; and this investigative process was the effort to de-escalate the solution and avoid heresy.

My term as Co-President involved creating new positions, processes and delegations from zero, with an interventive process no exception. By sticking to our core values, assessing the situation from all angles, and having hard conversations, we were able to maintain the safe culture OK champions.

Past UI/UX or leadership experience

- **The OK Foundation, Co-President:** Lead a team of 75+ creatives to facilitate an experiential design showcase, enhancing visual storytelling through audience journey mapping and spatial UX. Spearheaded leadership structure, including creating 8 new executive board positions, 2 committees. Led and restarted 10+ new community-oriented initiatives.
- **LavaLab, Founding Designer:** Led market research and 25+ user interviews, shaping product roadmap and feature set through agile iteration. Took on PM responsibilities as team bandwidth fluctuated.
- **Code the Change, Product Designer:** Worked with one co-designer to ship 9 user flows for iOS mobile and desktop apps, streamline data tracking for 20K+ MAU with 7 developers, 1 technical lead and 1 product manager.
- **Preface Health, UI/UX Design Intern:** Lead website redesign and chat interface for 15K+ MAU, creating prototypes, 7+ flows and 10+ design system components. Partner cross-functionally with co-founders for developer handoff and deployment.
- **Engram, Founding Designer:** Conceptualized from rapid iteration with 2 co-founders at a UCLA hackathon in 36 hours. Lead user research, GTM strategy, brand identity and website development, shipping a context-based API marketplace.

- **APASA, Programming Director:** Managed a \$35,000 budget and chair 4 committees to plan signature events, attracting over 3,000 students and empowering advocacy groups, resulting in a 200% increase in community engagement. Onboarded and collaborated with cross-functional teams, including 50+ nonprofits and student organizations, uniting the USC and greater LA communities through campus-wide exhibitions.
- **Troy Philippines, Director of Development:** Cofounded the USC Troy Philippines Scholarship through alumni networking and sponsorships while leading intern cohorts to support 200+ undergraduates through events and digital outreach. Developed and executed a social media strategy for alumni connection across Instagram, Facebook, and LinkedIn, boosting user engagement by 500%.

Other Details

Best trait for a UI/UX designer: "Taste: to sift through an oversaturated catalogue of AI-driven interfaces, tools and copy. A key differentiator among good and great designs is drawing a throughline among mediums and disciplines to extract its true artistry, and applying that to your own work."

Portfolio: joshuaplacido.com

Other commitments: "I don't anticipate being involved in anything other than InnoD! Might be a floater for CTC, LavaLab and OK but nothing crazy. Also only have 12 units for fall and spring semester!"

Anything else: :3

VII. VP of UI/UX — Kaitlin Chow

Applicant Info

Email	kkchow@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2027
First Choice	VP of UIUX
Other Positions	VP of Externals, VP of (Graphic) Design
InnoD Roles	General Member, Project Manager, Division VP, Committee Intern
Submitted	5/22/2026, 10:41 PM
Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this

I've seen people transition into design from completely unrelated

particular role?

100+ WORDS

fields, jumping from finance and HR to design. Witnessing those career shifts proved to me that you don't need a traditional four-year degree to find your footing here. Design is incredibly hands-on, and it's something you can pick up surprisingly fast if you have the right resources.

That's exactly why I love teaching design so much. I'm incredibly passionate about helping others build these skills from scratch. When you give newcomers structured mentorship and clear, practical tools, the learning curve just disappears. My goal is to break down the complex stuff and share the exact resources people need to realize that technical design is entirely within their reach.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of UI/UX

200+ WORDS

I want to introduce initiatives that encourage teams to start vibecoding their deliverables. The industry standard for designers is changing quickly, but the ability to use AI tools effectively is becoming a core skill. I want to push more AI-native workflows where designers use tools like v0, Bolt, or Claude to prototype and develop ideas directly through workshops, demos, and internal build challenges.

I also want to introduce initiatives that make critique sessions more meaningful. Right now, a lot of discussions in InnoD stay surface level because people are too nice or hesitant to speak up. I want to create systems that encourage stronger participation and more honest feedback, like a "feedback randomizer" that assigns critique perspectives or calls on people to respond so everyone contributes.

Lastly, I want to create better PM training around navigating ambiguity and client needs because I've seen a lot of teams struggle with this. Clients usually don't fully know what they want, so PMs need to get better at translating vague ideas into clear direction and priorities for the team. I already have workshop templates PMs can use to guide conversations and create alignment earlier in the process.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

When I was VP of Design, one of our clients, Buffs, was also working with Troy Labs. A lot of the designers felt overworked, weren't getting credit for their work, and felt like their creative input wasn't really being heard. Looking back, I realized I stepped in too late because I was trying to respect the PM's role and didn't want to overstep their decisions.

What I learned from that experience is that PMs should be focused on supporting the team, while leadership handles the pressure coming from external groups and clients. That's something I should've taken on earlier. Once I realized what was happening, I coordinated with the client to make an exit plan so we could finish the remaining deliverables without continuing to burn out the team.

Past UI/UX or leadership experience

- Head of Product at Series
- Ramp Product Design Intern
- Handshake Product Design Intern
- VP of Design InnoD
- Figma Campus Leader
- 5+ Startup Contractor Roles

Other Details

Best trait for a UI/UX designer: "The ability to bring structure and clarity to complex problems"

Portfolio: x.com/_kachoww

Other commitments: GX (intend to take this pretty seriously); working part time at a tea shop? idk wanna do smth fun

Anything else: "Sorry this is late LOL ik you guys have had to chase me a bit to apply"

VIII. VP of (Graphic) Design — Jaimie Liao

Applicant Info

Email	liaojaim@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2028
First Choice	VP of (Graphic) Design
Other Positions	VP of Community, VP of Marketing
InnoD Roles	General Member, Committee Intern
Submitted	5/18/2026, 7:32 PM
Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

After being a Design GM for two semesters now, I'm ready to grow into a new role in InnoD, and Design VP seems like a really great way to gain leadership experience and be exposed to another aspect of design that would allow me to develop skills that will be valuable no matter what field I end up going into.

I would say I'm most excited to find clients to work with, since I already catch myself studying the branding of different stores that I walk into and analyzing the areas where their visual identity could be stronger. However, I also hope to develop my communication skills, especially in being more confident and well-spoken in professional settings.

Mentoring is definitely something that I am nervous about, especially because I have so many skills that I still want to learn, and I know there are still so many ways that I can grow as a designer. Despite this, I think mentorship extends beyond technical skills, and I see myself as being someone approachable and supportive that PMs and GMs can feel comfortable talking to. Regardless, I know I'd help in whatever ways I can, and will also do my best to find the answers to questions I'm personally unsure of.

Overall, I would say I genuinely grew so much as a designer through InnoD, and this club has helped me develop a lot through my transition from the fine arts into more digital and industry-level design applications. I would love to have a bigger role in shaping the semester's experience for future new members and helping create that same kind of environment where people feel like they can grow both creatively and professionally.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of Design

200+ WORDS

Design encompasses so many different skills and across so many different industries, and one of my biggest goals as Design VP would be to push the extent to which the clients we work with reflect that diversity. Design can take the form of packaging, logos, sticker packs, branding, PR boxes, publications, motion graphics, and so much more, all of which work with different skillsets and software. I hope to find a range of clients that ask for varying deliverables, so that the designer who wants to work on motion graphics can grow just as much as the designer who wants to work on creating brand guidelines.

This idea also relates to one of my personal struggles. In my opinion, one of the main ways to see whether a specific industry is one you'd like to pursue is through internships, but with only a few summers available before graduation, it can feel impossible to decide by then what industry you'd want to pursue as a full-time career. Finding clients across industries — from fashion to retail to entertainment and beyond — would allow designers to gain exposure to different kinds of creative work, giving them the opportunity to experiment in different areas and discover what they enjoy best.

Another initiative I would like to focus on is fostering a stronger sense of connection and collaboration within the division itself, which is something I've observed specifically in Media/Photo team. I think doing so would not only build the relationship within the design community but also give designers more of a chance to learn from one another. I remember we had one breakout session where we swapped teams and shared our work with other PMs and designers. I would love to expand on this by creating a more structured opportunity for designers to receive feedback from other PMs. I think it's very valuable to hear from an outside perspective, and doing so would also help bridge the client teams, which currently feel separated as people between teams don't interact as much and aren't informed about each other's work.

Outside of Monday club meetings, I also think it could be beneficial to initiate more casual work sessions modeled after fam hangouts, where whoever is free can just pull up to work. Currently, the Friday design workshops can be hard for people to attend because they may overlap with classes, and since InnoD is already a pretty time-consuming club, asking people to take even more time out of their day for additional workshops can add up. I think having a lower-stakes environment — such as these work sessions — where designers can ask questions, get feedback, and consistently see what other client teams are working on outside of mid-semester check-ins, would not only help people grow as designers but also give them a chance to bond with one another and strengthen the

sense of community within the division. Hopefully, in doing so, people become open to going to each other for help and feel more comfortable reaching out.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

Last semester, as part of our work for Birdie Tea, we had to work with a client who didn't have a clear vision for their rebrand and frequently changed their mind, especially in the initial stages. This caused us to need to shift directions from week to week, which made it difficult to make progress and stay on track with our deliverable timeline.

While this would usually be something I'd get frustrated over, I understand that with client work, they are the ones trusting us and paying for a service, and our work should ultimately be guided by what they want, not just our own creative preferences. Dealing with this conflict became about maintaining patience, adapting to the new ideas they gave us each week, and not becoming too attached to either one of their directions or my own.

At the same time, one of my biggest takeaways from this conflict and working with a client like this was to have confidence in your own ideas and not be afraid to pitch them, even if they differ from the client's vision. Designers are hired for their creative perspective, and so I do see the importance of finding this balance between upholding the client's goal but also advocating for design decisions that I genuinely believe are strong and effective choices.

Past design or leadership experience

Design experience:

- Editorials for SPEC, SCene, Haute Magazine
- Graphics for 840 West Records
- Signage for USC ITS Learning Environments
- InnoD design gm & marketing intern

Leadership:

- Field hockey captain
- Track and field captain
- Fundraising team lead

Other Details

Best trait for a designer: "I think the best trait for a designer to have is flexibility. Designers need to balance user experience, client desires, and personal preference, all while adapting to feedback and being ready to pivot directions. Flexibility allows designers to create consistent yet intentional work, even when projects change unexpectedly."

Portfolio: liaojaim.myportfolio.com

Other commitments: climbing club, 840 west records (?)

IX. VP of (Graphic) Design — Robert Vo

Applicant Info

Email	rxvo@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2029
First Choice	VP of (Graphic) Design
Other Positions	VP of Marketing
InnoD Roles	General Member
Submitted	5/22/2026, 10:55 PM (resubmitted; original 5/18/2026)
Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

There's this gravitational force pulling me into the role of VP of Design shouting at me as I sit in Birnkrant in my dimly lit room looking over all of the drunk people hopping out of their Fryfts at 1:55am. I sketch out in my Moleskine the feeling that I had after reading the Slack message to apply for VP of Design one more time, and I realize that this feeling—this force that is pulling me into VP of design, is my ambition to be.

To be someone's mentor.

To be an overseer of client projects.

To be a cold emailer.

To be a friend.

Being VP of design is more than just overseeing all the client projects and ensuring that deliverables are made by the hand-off deadline.

For me, being VP of design, means to be a designer with others and growing with them. Although there is this list of responsibilities that I must complete as VP of Design, it doesn't compare to the unlisted responsibilities that I must carry. To support, advise, and give love to members within the design division, to make sure that they feel heard and want to do more than what they are expected, even if I don't have the skillset to help them succeed. I want to not seem superior to everyone else within the division, but rather as a support. I want to encourage people to dive deep into their design ambitions, have PMs grow exponentially, and make clients feel heard.

This infrastructure of responsibilities, set up like a duplex, is what truly interests me in the role of VP of Design. Each week, I'm able to connect with all the designers and build new compartments within our home that we call InnoD, to gain knowledge on how to use figma in new ways, make Canva more intuitive for clients, or lessons to share from past client projects. The gravitational pole that I felt writing in my Moleskine is how I hope people will feel when they have me as VP of Design, so we can all build our own part of the VP of Design duplex together.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of Design

200+ WORDS

Initiative #1: Strengthen Project Manager (PM) Curriculum and Structure

With this initiative, I strive to strengthen our existing PM system via more extensive training, weekly meetings, and assistance during client meetings. An internal system needs to be built for PMs to have a safeguard in what they can do, what they should do, and how they should approach clients, difficult designers, and understanding their own role as a PM to their designer. However, this is on the PM to uphold, not only the VP of Design as that would be unfair to VPs in the future.

1 – PM Training Conference (PMTTC): This would be mandatory for all PMs to attend, even if they had been a PM in the past. Having past PMs would allow for advice for new nervous PMs to ask questions that they might have and for an advice session to happen. Contents related to the PMTC: Communicating with clients (conflicts, understanding, and educating); "Client is god" — being able to compromise; Being a PM means being a middleman; PM and designer relationships (how they work, reminders, being encouraging); Understanding who their client is with designers (including other PMs for cross-divisional client); Workshop: I am client, and they have to create a plan with me.

2 – Weekly Check-In with PMs: This may occur already behind the scenes and may be unnecessary during some weeks, but I would like to make sure that I check in with the PMs weekly to see how they are doing and managing their designers as it is not an easy task. Seeing if they do have the patients for it and if they need help with clients. Occur once a week, preferably all of the PMs together; Discuss client meetings, updates with designs, etc; Troubleshooting and workshopping any issues; Making sure that they are keep their designers updated.

3 – Communication + Support: This is for the support of the PMs at the initial communications with the client and to ensure consistent and professional communication. PM to Client: VP attends first three client meetings (evaluate if need to attend future meetings); After first three client meetings, PM MUST send VP of design a summary of the meeting; Communication should be over email and VP should be CC'd on all communications, this includes the client CC'ing the VP as well; All documents should live natively on Notion where the client, designers, PM, and VP should be able to access at all times and updated promptly. PM to designers: VP should be in group chat with all of the designers and PMs; VP shouldn't overstep within group chat, and the PM can call out VP if overstepping happens; VP attends first two team meetings to see workflow, offer support, etc.

(if they're able to attend); PM MUST send summary of the team meeting 30 minutes after the conclusion of the meeting to the entire team + VP.

Initiative #2: Design Workshops for Noobs During InnoLaunch/Before Client Assignments

With this initiative, I strive to bridge the gap between a designer and their skills for them to be successful during their semester at InnoD with client work. For many noob designers, like myself, they don't know what to do during client projects, or how working for a client works. Much of the teaching should come from the PM, however, these would supplement what the PM doesn't teach and help these new designers to fully understand the client service process. Moreover, these workshops would include self-fulfillment aspects as well, so new designers can see what they can get from being in InnoD rather than community, and being free labor. Workshops: Portfolio making; How to use Figma; How to Develop Brand Guidelines; Understanding that client behaviors; PM and Designer bonding time; Client work process; How to use client work to align with their goals (picking a client!). Additionally, I would like to gain feedback from the design division to see what they would like to learn, as well as, create cross-divisional workshops for those who want to get into UI/UX as a design GM and vice versa. Also, I would like to improve the notion folder of past client projects to be more readable and accessible so members can look back at previous work and gain inspiration for their current client projects.

Initiative #3: Brand CSR — Designing with Purpose

With this initiative, I strive to bring corporate social responsibility to our design process leading into client projects. Many clients in the future may be similar to CAYJ, where brand empathy is important. This would allow the reputation of InnoD to stay strong, but also improve our designers in the process. Additionally, making sure that we design with purpose is important as many members (or maybe myself), would just create designs to make deadlines or for the sake of their portfolio, however, I want to make sure that work is purposeful and useful to the bigger picture of the client project.

- Educating designing with purpose, intent, and people with disabilities
- Hosting a workshop/GM about designing by looking at factors like color contrast, readability, audiences, etc, for audiences with disabilities or impairments (guest speaker possibility)
- Informing clients who may not know CSR; not directly teaching them, but giving them evidence to why we may believe that these design or ideas may not fit in with their audiences
- Critiques during division breakouts and each designer explain WHY they created their design in that way to the entire division

- During division breakouts, each client team will meet first, and then each team will present what they have to the other teams for cross-team critiquing, and weekly progress checks (motivation and community booster!)

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

CAYJ and I were in an arranged marriage where neither of us would look at each other.

Even though I dove into CAYJ with strong ambitions and aspirations, like every marriage, every moment with them, criticizing comments would be shouted, or I would go untouched by the end of the night... my designs, not me physically.

The comments spread across Figma, my emails, and texts from them felt like a sharp pain in my stomach as it whispers into my ear at the sound of each notification that I have no place in this client project, that I have no place in being a creative. It felt like criticism with no direction, advice with no substance, an idea with no execution. Storm clouds would form above my head as I sat during division breakouts knowing that it would be another week where I would be creating for it to be discarded, that I would be discarded once again.

As a designer, I was being silenced.

But, why?

I never seemed to ask myself, "Why does the client feel this way? Why does the client feel that they CAN act this way? How do they see me as a designer?". I took to heart every comment I saw on Figma, every summarizing text that my PM would send after each client meeting, every gleaming moment that I saw my other designers work get praised while mine stayed untouched.

I needed to dive deeper into the "why?", the reasoning behind their doubts, the reasoning behind why they believe in the idea that they have for their brand.

I began to step into the bright red tennis shoes that I saw them wear during client meetings as I began to attend them, seeing how they held their character, how they delivered their comments, and the uncertainty within their voices. Behind each word, I saw notes of doubt and naiveness in their ideas.

I approached this conflict that I had with CAYJ by being a being in the front lines. I began to attend client meetings, asked for feedback, and allowed for my designs to marinate before I handed them off. I began designing with intent and the purpose that each design within this CAYJ ecosystem was there to empower youth and educate, rather than promote youth incarceration. This conflict was about cutting out the middle man and figuring out realigning my goals for the client. I began to advocate for myself and my idea, using my personal experiences working with non-profit organizations to support my process. I began to create goals for CAYJ that aligned with what they wanted, with what they liked about my designs.

Conflict resolution is about communication and understanding every perspective involved. It starts with introspection, then externally later. If I can't fix the conflict on my own, then how will I fix it by complaining first? I approach conflict with curiosity and optimism, with support from others, and the hopes of being able to find a compromise, the hopes in being able to make that arranged marriage into one of love instead.

Past design or leadership experience

- Innovative Design (Design General Member)
- Descent Magazine (Social Media Manager for Graphics)

High school experience (all include leadership + design):

- **PNW Key Club — District Board Membership Growth and Reactivation Committee Chair:** Facilitated a committee with 12 committee members; Held weekly and bi-weekly meetings through Zoom & Google Meet; Hosted a webinar with 30 attendees; Developed and designed membership retention & reactivation resources; Hosted a workshop about club retention at District Convention with ~300 attendees; Achieved 98% of the membership goal (~11,800 members).
- **Lieutenant Governor of Division 62 (Portland Metropolitan Area/8 Clubs):** Held 2 massive joint service events with an attendance of ~160 members; Donated 143 toys, 388 food items, 500 hygiene items and 1000 service hours; Held 7 services events pertaining to youth houselessness (average attendance 50); Created monthly email newsletters through Mailchimp; Regularly maintained Instagram through recognition and recap posts (3x/week); Held an officer training conference for 30 officers; Reactivated 2 Key Clubs; Held monthly presidents meetings; Attended 5 board meetings & 2 District Conventions; Held a workshop "how to get a date" with 200+ attendees; Spoke a district convention in front of 1.5k members.
- **Key Club President (Co-Founder):** Re-establish Key Club into high school after disbandment; Held clothing drive with over 200 donations; Recruited 98 paid members; Provided over 100 hours worth of service opportunities; Connected with on campus and local elementary schools to host service events; Managed a board of 6 people.
- **David Douglas High School — ASB Head of Communications:** Curated Instagram and gained 3,600 followers with a cumulative 2.5 million views; Designed graphics and posters for school-wide events, weekly updates, and recognition; Recording ASB meeting minutes via Google Docs; Manage a committee of 10 members assigning tasks, updating checklists daily, etc.

- **Student Council Social Media and Public Relations Committee Lead:** Manage a committee of 10 members assigning tasks, updating checklists daily, etc; Created a subcommittee system to improve efficiency in content creation; Recognized marginalized student groups through utilization of committee members and the student groups that they are a part of.
- **Student Council Social Media and Public Relations Committee Member:** Developed a website school for over 3,000 users for students, staff, and district board members; Pioneered the "weekly overview" format for all class of 20XX accounts; Assisted sophomore class president in managing class of 2025 account to post 3x a week.
- **Presidential Council Representative (School Policy and Climate Committee):** Met with other student leaders around school to discuss school climate and culture; identified problems and created solutions around campus; Presented and collaborated with school board in created solutions; Interviewed principal candidates for the upcoming school year to help with hiring; Provided input on new CTE building development and planning.
- **HOSA Mental Health Promotion (Research, Designing Graphics, and PM):** 10 week mental health campaign that focused on anxiety; Researched for social media posts on campaigns through academic articles; Design website and social media posts; Worked with 2 other group members to execute campaign and present at competition; Place 2nd in Oregon HOSA.
- **SchnitzerCare Communication Team Lead:** Email nonprofits and SchitzerCare liaison; Designed social media posts for fundraisers; Delegated tasks to communication team member (4) over the course of 3 months; Granted \$14,000+ dollars to nonprofits at gala, including giving a speech at gala in front of all of the nonprofit executives directors and board members.
- **Link Crew Leader:** Toured freshmen and 8th graders around high school; Maintained constant communication with advisory teacher; Taught 30-minute weekly lessons during freshmen advisory; Executed one-on-one check-ins with assigned freshmen 4 times throughout the school year; Ran and assisted with freshmen events (football tailgate, study sessions, etc).

Other Details

Best trait for a designer: "'Closed mouths don't get fed'. Meaning: They are not afraid to ask questions about anything that they are curious, confused, or excited about. A designer should never be afraid to ask questions to a client, themselves, or their collaborators about anything."

Portfolio: [Google Drive folder](#)

Other commitments: Descent Magazine - Social Media Manager

X. VP of (Graphic) Design — Jonathan Ho

Applicant Info	Email	hojonath@usc.edu
	Graduating	May 2029
	First Choice	VP of (Graphic) Design
	Other Positions	VP of UIUX, VP of Media
	InnoD Roles	General Member
	Submitted	5/22/2026, 11:17 PM
	Can attend Mon 8–10PM	Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

I joined InnoD because I wanted to work on real-world design projects. With Talulah and Maison Gauche, I feel like I've gained plenty of experience with exactly that: real-world clients that need tangible solutions. I enjoyed the GM—PM structure within teams and the iteration cycles and critiques, and continued to build my skillset as a teammate.

Yet, I don't feel completely satisfied with these projects. It's harder to say what exactly I've gained from these projects as a designer. I'm sure other returning mems share the same sentiment, but I really hope to change that for new mems. As Design VP, I want to make InnoD a place where creatives grow interpersonally and creatively/technically, and I believe that elevating client projects—a core facet of InnoD—is the first step we can take to get there.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of Design

200+ WORDS

InnoD is a space for creatives to grow. This means that for designers and photographers alike should be challenged by their projects. My main goals begin with client recruitment. I want to recruit clients that are looking for something new, projects that require solutions beyond ordinary and that will take advantage of our members' fullest potentials. This goal would directly influence our selectivity when recruiting, which would call for starting earlier and extending InnoD's reach further.

Unique projects like these call for my second initiative: assembling a diverse incoming hex class that aspires to work on projects like these. I plan on executing this by gauging applicants' interests in aspects of the future creative industry, like novel tools.

Third, I want to nurture and maintain positive relationships with our clients moving forward. With clients often being startups or local businesses, I believe that there are more opportunities for members—whether that be future work or network—stemming from these clients.

Finally, I love the interclub events and open opportunities that InnoD offers, like Riptide, CreateSC, community critiques, and kickbacks. I want to take this one step further by working with Externals and Community to organize trips to creative studios like Riot Games' or even museums like The Broad. Along the same lines, I want to utilize InnoD's network to bring in industry professionals during our GMs who can share their experiences, offer real-world insight, and act as a point of inspiration for members.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

I recently worked with a client on a few Photoshop graphics for their launch. The original timeline was about one month, but when when one month rolled around, we had made less-than-ideal progress due to indecision and constant changes and tweaks. At this point, I touched base with my client, explaining that I would sprint through the design process on my own, showing him the results once they're complete. I think that this exchange not only returned his confidence in the project but also offered a sense of security that the deadline would not get pushed back an unforeseeable amount.

This conflict showed me that the expression often used in hospitality, "The customer is always right," doesn't exactly work in the design and creative industry, where the designer was chosen so that they can take lead. Of course, underlying all of this, I knew that properly communicating with my client through this conflict saved the project.

Past design or leadership experience

I was the Design Editor of the yearbook in my junior year of high school. This meant teaching designers my self-made curriculum for InDesign, Illustrator, and Photoshop every week for the first two months of the semester. On top of that, I'd led the "branding" of the book, or what we like to call theme development. During the semester, I was constantly giving feedback to designers during my own "office hours," checking in on team managers, all while designing spreads myself. This made me extremely comfortable with leadership in design contexts.

Senior year, when I became Editor-in-Chief, I was challenged in areas outside of design that helped me grow as a leader. It was this role that, by forcing me to go beyond my little design bubble within the org, taught me the importance of building positive relationships with everyone in the org, not just the people I worked with the most often.

Other Details

Best trait for a designer: "A designer ultimately should have initiative. They should have confidence in their vision enough to be proactive and make decisions on their own. In contexts where speed is prioritized, this means skipping feedback after every step and simply presenting a design once built out. Often, nobody knows what the right direction is in the middle of the design process. In this case, a designer's proactivity and initiative will do one of two things: concretize the right solution or expose an incorrect solution."

Portfolio: jonathanho.design

Other commitments: TAO Historian (probably under 3 hours a week, GM one night a week, day TBD); Lavalab Designer

Anything else: "thanks for taking the time to read :)"

XI. VP of Photo — Joy Wang

Applicant Info

Email	joyjwang@usc.edu
Graduating	May 2027
First Choice	VP of Photo
Other Positions	—
InnoD Roles	General Member, Project Manager, Division VP, Committee Intern
Submitted	5/23/2026, 12:52 AM

Can attend Mon
8–10PM

Of course

Why are you interested in this particular role?

100+ WORDS

Innovative Design has been my favorite community since my first semester here at USC, and the role is an opportunity to give back meaningfully to an organization that means a lot to me. Serving as the VP of Media last year deepened my understanding of how the organization runs and reinforced my sense of responsibility within it. This experience has also given me a clear understanding of what I'd like to improve for the team, particularly around client recruitment and curriculum development. Going into the upcoming school year, I want to bring what I've learned as VP to build a more creatively fulfilling experience for members, and just as welcoming as when I first joined.

Main goals or initiatives as VP of Media

200+ WORDS

One of my main goals is to make curriculum building more intentional. Past breakout sessions and workshops haven't been the most successful, partly because members have different styles and interests within photography or videography. To address this, I want to work with the project managers early on to plan out key topics in advance, ideally building the curriculum upon the client projects happening that semester. I'd also like to incorporate more hands-on experiences, such as photo walks and editing sessions, to make learning more engaging. One idea I didn't get to execute last spring was hosting a studio workshop with a professional photographer, and that's something I'd love to make happen this year.

The other area I want to focus on is client recruitment. A lot of effort goes into the process, and I think there's room to make it more efficient and targeted. I'd like to collaborate with the other Division VPs ahead of recruitment season to build a more streamlined system. Some ideas I have are building a greater client-facing presence through social media and LinkedIn, taking a more personal, referral-based approach to outreach, and connecting with prospective clients in other ways beyond cold emails and DMs. Beyond just filling spots, I also want to be more intentional about the media projects we take on, prioritizing work that's genuinely rewarding and relatively frictionless for our members.

Dealing with conflict within a team or with a client

100+ WORDS

Last fall, I oversaw the Kook client project, where there was misalignment between the project managers and clients that led to deliverables that didn't match the client's vision. When the client reached out to me directly, I scheduled a call with them to understand their concerns. Rather than reshooting, I worked with the project managers to recurate and re-edit our preexisting photos. For the following lifestyle shoot, we ensured a more structured pre-shoot approval process going forward to prevent the same issue from recurring. This experience taught me that visual alignment requires clearly defined success criteria before execution.

Past photo/video or leadership experience

- Photo General Member (F23–F24) — Collaborated with a team on semesterly client projects
- Photo Project Manager (S25) — Oversaw the CALIFORNICA client project
- Photo/Media Vice President (F25–S26) — Led the Media (formerly photo) Division

Other Details

Best trait for a photographer/videographer: "Proactivity! The best photos or videos are the result of always thinking one step ahead, whether that means repositioning for a better angle, experimenting with settings, or staying attuned to what's happening around them. Taking these small extra steps consistently leads to strong work."

Portfolio: joywang.myportfolio.com

Other commitments: Staff photographer Daily Trojan

Anything else: :DDD

